

Shuning Li

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

Department of Economics, Western University

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Research Interests

Labor Economics; Applied Microeconometrics; Family Economics

Education

Ph.D. in Economics , Western University, London, ON 2022–present

– Ph.D. Scholarship (2022–2025)

M.A. in Economics (with honors) , Nanjing University, Nanjing, China 2019–2021

– GPA: 92/100, Rank: 1/7

– Thesis: *Trade Barriers and Overcapacity: Evidence from the Tariff War between China and the US* (Best Research Master’s Thesis in Jiangsu Province)

B.A. in Economics (with honors) , Sun Yat-sen University, Guangzhou, China 2015–2019

– GPA: 90/100, Rank: 6/33

– Thesis: *Does Business Start-up Reform Increase Market Entry?* (High Distinction, Top 5%)

– Top Graduate of Lingnan College, Valedictorian of Class 2019

Publications

“**Vertical Structure, Managerial Delegation, and the Choice of Capacity**”, with Jiancai Pi. *Journal of Central University of Finance & Economics*, Jan 2022, pp. 89–98.

“**Vertical Structure and Wage Inequality**”, with Jiancai Pi and Shumin Yu. *International Journal of Economic Theory*, 2026, 22(2), pp. 161–182.

Working Papers

“**Marriage Squeeze and Education Choice: Evidence from China’s Imbalanced Sex Ratios**”. *Memo*, May 2025.

“**Child Penalties and the Reallocation of Mothers’ Career Paths**”.

Conference Presentations

“**Marriage Squeeze and Education Choice: Evidence from China’s Imbalanced Sex Ratios**”, Canadian Economics Association Annual Conference, Vancouver, 2026.

Research Experience

Research Assistant – Prof. Lance Lochner, Western University 2024–present
Conducted data analysis and visualizations in Stata; estimated composite investment prices for ongoing research

Research Assistant – Prof. Audra Bowlus, Western University 2025–present
Conducted analysis on human capital and wage growth using LISA data

Jiangsu Province “333” Project: Institutional Overcapacity 2020–2021
Developed sequential game models and applied stochastic frontier analysis to study trade barriers and capacity utilization; results incorporated into Master’s thesis and journal publication.

National Social Science Fund Project: Business System Reform 2018–2019
Field surveys across 16 provinces; managed data group; built Stata database; results cited in reform assessments. Undergraduate thesis based on this project awarded Excellent Thesis (Top 5%).

Teaching Experience

Western University, Teaching Assistant 2022–present

- PhD courses: Macroeconomics, Economic Mathematics
- Master course: Macroeconomic Theory for Finance
- Undergraduate courses: Principles of Macroeconomics, Econometrics

Honors and Awards

Ph.D. Scholarship, Western University (2022–2025)
CHCP Graduate Fellowship (2026)
Best Research Master’s Thesis in Jiangsu Province (2023)
Honored Graduate, Nanjing University (2021)
First-class Student Scholarship, Nanjing University (2019–2022, Top 1%)
Honored Graduate, Sun Yat-sen University (2019)
Top Graduate of Lingnan College, Sun Yat-sen University (2019)
Excellent Undergraduate Thesis, Sun Yat-sen University (2019, Top 1%)
First-class Student Scholarship, Sun Yat-sen University (2017, 2018)
Hongxin Scholarship (2018); International Exchange Scholarship (2017)
Xinhua Insurance Scholarship (2016)
First Prize, Challenge Cup National College Student Contest (2021)
“Survey China” Top 15, South Reviews (2020)

Skills

Programming: Stata, R, Matlab, Mathematica, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Julia
Languages: Mandarin (native), English (fluent)

Last updated: June 22, 2026